AI SOLUTION HUB

AI Suitability Assessment Report

Prepared by AI Solution Hub

Prepared for

AMD Group
Design. Deliver. Maintain.

Generated: 16 January 2026

Table of Contents

ID	Category	Department	Verdict	Page
Report Sections				
Executive Summary		Overview of assessment results and key findings		3
How to Use This Report		Guide to understanding verdicts and assessments		4
Getting Started with AI Tools		Overview of Claude tiers and recommendations		6
Data Protection Guidelines		Consolidated data handling requirements		7
Use Case Assessments				
UC-001	Report Generation	Operations / MEP Project Delivery	Probably suitable	9
UC-002	Predictive Analytics	Operations / MEP Project Delivery	Partially suitable	10
UC-003	Financial Analysis	Operations / MEP Project Delivery	Partially suitable	11
UC-004	Compliance Checking	Operations / MEP Project Delivery	Probably suitable	12
UC-005	Communication Management	Estimating	Yes, AI can help	13
UC-006	Data Analysis	Estimating	Probably suitable	14
UC-007	Report Generation	Estimating	Probably suitable	15
UC-008	Quantity Surveying	Estimating	Not recommended	16
UC-009	Document Summarisation	Estimating	Yes, AI can help	17
UC-010	Administrative Automation	Admin/Office	Not recommended	18
UC-011	Communication Automation	Admin/Office	Yes, AI can help	19
UC-012	Workflow Automation	Admin/Office	Partially suitable	20
UC-013	Compliance Monitoring	Admin/Office	Not recommended	21
UC-014	Bid Writing	Admin/Office	Yes, AI can help	22
UC-015	Document Creation	Admin/Office	Yes, AI can help	23
UC-016	Document Control	Admin/Office	Partially suitable	24
UC-017	Meeting Automation	Admin/Office	Yes, AI can help	25
UC-018	Task Management	Admin/Office	Yes, AI can help	26
UC-019	Email Intelligence	Admin/Office	Yes, AI can help	27
UC-020	Research	Admin/Office	Partially suitable	28
UC-021	Expense Automation	Admin/Office	Partially suitable	29
UC-022	Contract Generation	Admin/Office	Partially suitable	30
UC-023	Compliance Documentation	Admin/Office	Probably suitable	31

Executive Summary

This report presents the results of 23 AI suitability assessments conducted across various SMB use cases. Each assessment evaluates whether generative AI is suitable for a specific task, recommends appropriate tools and approaches, and highlights key considerations.

Verdict Distribution

Verdict	Count	%
Yes, AI can help	8	34.8%
Partially suitable	7	30.4%
Probably suitable	5	21.7%
Not recommended	3	13.0%

Recommended Tools

Tool Type	Count	%
Claude AI	15	65.2%
Third-Party Tools	4	17.4%
Automation Platform	3	13.0%
Specialist Tool	1	4.3%

Quick Wins - Ready for AI

These use cases are highly suitable for AI assistance and offer clear benefits:

UC-005: Communication Management

Email prioritisation and sorting is well-suited to AI assistance with appropriate tool selection and setup.

UC-009: Document Summarisation

AI is highly suitable for extracting and summarising key requirements from lengthy specifications, significantly reducing reading time whilst enabling thorough analysis.

UC-011: Communication Automation

AI is highly suitable for drafting supply chain emails from templates, saving significant time on routine communications.

UC-014: Bid Writing

AI is highly suitable for managing PQQ responses - it can effectively search previous answers, adapt content to new questions, and ensure consistency across submissions.

UC-015: Document Creation

AI transcription and summarisation tools are highly effective for converting meeting recordings and notes into structured minutes, offering significant time savings with proper review.

How to Use This Report

Understanding the Verdicts

Each use case has been assigned a verdict indicating AI suitability:

- **Yes, AI can help** – Highly suitable for AI assistance with clear benefits and low risk
- **Probably suitable** – AI can help effectively, but requires human review or specific precautions
- **Partially suitable** – Some aspects benefit from AI, others require human judgement or alternative approaches
- **Not recommended** – AI is not appropriate for this task due to risk, accuracy requirements, or better alternatives

Reading Each Assessment

Each assessment includes: a **verdict summary** with key takeaways, detailed **reasoning** explaining the analysis, a **recommended approach** with specific implementation steps, and **key considerations** to keep in mind.

How These Assessments Were Generated

This report was generated using **"Can I AI This?"**, an AI suitability assessment tool developed by AI Solution Hub. The tool helps organisations evaluate whether generative AI is suitable for specific tasks, and provides guidance on the best approach for implementation.

The Assessment Process

Each use case was assessed through a structured question flow designed to gather the key information needed for an accurate evaluation:

1. **Task Description:** A detailed description of what the task involves and what outcome is needed
2. **Frequency:** How often the task is performed (one-off, daily, weekly, monthly, etc.)
3. **What It Involves:** The types of work required (writing, analysis, data processing, research, etc.)
4. **Information Source:** Where the input data comes from (internal documents, external sources, customer data, etc.)
5. **Risk Level:** The sensitivity of the data and potential consequences of errors

AI-Powered Analysis

Based on these inputs, each assessment is processed by Claude, Anthropic's AI assistant, using a curated knowledge base that includes:

- Best practices for AI implementation in business contexts
- Tool capabilities and limitations across different AI platforms
- Industry-specific considerations and compliance requirements
- Data handling and security guidelines

Getting Started with AI Tools

Many assessments in this report recommend using AI chat assistants such as Claude, ChatGPT, or similar tools. This section provides an overview of the available options to help you choose the right tier for your needs.

Claude (Recommended)

Claude is developed by Anthropic and is the AI assistant used to generate these assessments. It excels at analysis, writing, and following detailed instructions.

Claude Free

Free

Best for: Testing and occasional use

- Limited messages per day (varies based on demand)
- Access to Claude Sonnet model
- Standard response times
- Good for evaluating whether Claude suits your needs before committing to a paid plan

Claude Pro

£16/month

Best for: Individual professionals with regular AI needs

- 5x more usage than the free tier
- Priority access during high-demand periods
- Access to all models including Claude Opus 4.5
- Early access to new features
- Suitable for daily professional use

Claude Team

£20-24/seat/month

Best for: Teams and organisations handling sensitive business data

- All Pro features included
- Higher usage limits than Pro
- **Commercial data protections:** Your data is not used to train AI models
- Central billing and user management
- Admin controls and usage analytics
- Recommended for business-critical tasks involving confidential information

Important - Data Protection: When handling sensitive business data, client information, or confidential documents, always use a paid tier with commercial data protections (such as Claude Team or ChatGPT Enterprise). Free tiers may use your conversations to improve their models. Review each provider's data handling policies before processing sensitive information.

Data Protection Guidelines

Important: All use cases in this report involve data that requires careful handling. The following guidelines apply to every assessment.

Never Input to Free AI Tools

- Client names, project addresses, contract values
- Personal data (employee names, addresses, NI numbers)
- Commercially sensitive information (pricing, supplier terms, tender details)

Anonymisation Approach

Before using AI tools, replace sensitive data with placeholders:

- Client names → "Client A", "Client B"
- Project locations → "Northern site", "Project 123"
- Individual names → "Employee A", "two engineers"
- Financial figures → Use ranges or percentages

Recommended Claude Tier by Data Type

Data Type	Recommended Tier	Notes
Internal business data (aggregated, anonymised)	Claude Free/Pro	Disable training in Account Settings → Data Controls
Commercial sensitive data (client work)	Claude Team (£20-24/user/month)	Commercial data protection terms
Personal data / GDPR scope	Claude Team/Enterprise	Required for GDPR compliance

GDPR Compliance

If processing personal data using AI tools:

- Document your lawful basis under UK GDPR Article 6
- Ensure Data Processing Agreements (DPAs) are in place
- Microsoft Power Automate operates under your existing M365 agreement
- Third-party tools require signing their DPA

Individual Assessments

Verdict Key

- Yes — Highly suitable
- Probably — Suitable with review
- Partially — Some aspects suitable
- No — Not recommended

UC-001: Report Generation

Probably suitable

Verdict

> AI is well-suited for drafting weekly progress reports from your source materials, but human review is essential before client distribution to ensure accuracy and appropriate tone.

Department: Operations / MEP Project Delivery | **Role:** Electrical Contracts Manager

Task Description

> *I need to write weekly progress reports for clients. Each week I gather information from project drawings, site notes, and schedules, then write an update covering what's completed, what's delayed, and what's planned for the next week. The report needs to go into our company template before I review and send it to the client.*

Reasoning

Weekly progress reports represent an excellent AI use case because they follow a predictable structure, involve synthesising information from multiple sources, and occur frequently enough to justify the setup effort. AI tools like Claude excel at taking bullet points or raw data and transforming them into professional, well-structured prose.

The'probably' rather than 'yes' rating reflects two important considerations: First, client-facing communications require careful review to ensure factual accuracy, appropriate tone, and that no sensitive information is inadvertently included. Second, you'll need to establish a process for sanitising project data before inputting it to AI tools—particularly if using free-tier services where data may be used for training.

The time investment makes strong business sense. If each report currently takes 45-60 minutes to write, AI assistance could reduce this to 15-20 minutes (gathering information, prompting AI, reviewing and refining output). Over a year, that's approximately 20-30 hours saved—substantial value for a single subscription or careful use of free tiers.

Recommended Approach

Tool: Claude.ai (Pro recommended for regular use)

Method: Upload your source materials (anonymised if using free tier), provide a structured prompt with your company's report format, and iterate with Claude to refine tone and emphasis. Build a reusable prompt template that you simply update each week with new information.

Implementation Steps

1. **Step 1:** Gather and prepare your source materials: site notes, schedule updates, and completion information. If using free tier, remove or anonymise client names, specific addresses, and commercially sensitive details.
2. **Step 2:** Create a master prompt template that includes your report structure (sections like 'Work Completed This Week', 'Current Issues/Delays', 'Next Week's Priorities'), preferred tone (professional but approachable), and any standard information that doesn't change week-to-week.
3. **Step 3:** Start a new Claude conversation, paste your template prompt, and upload or paste your week's information. Ask Claude to generate the first draft.
4. **Step 4:** Review the output carefully: verify all facts, dates, and figures; check the tone is appropriate for this specific client; ensure no sensitive details were included; confirm the emphasis matches your professional judgement.
5. **Step 5:** Refine with follow-up prompts such as 'Make the delays section more diplomatic' or 'Add more technical detail about the electrical work'. Iterate until satisfied.
6. **Step 6:** Copy the finalised text into your company template, add any required branding or formatting, and conduct a final review before sending to the client.

Key Considerations

- AI may occasionally misinterpret technical terminology or project-specific jargon—always verify technical details against your source materials before sending
- The tone and emphasis of progress reports require professional judgement: AI provides a draft, but you determine what to highlight or downplay based on client relationship and project context
- For free tier usage, establishing a consistent anonymisation process is essential—create a checklist of what must be removed before AI processing
- Client-facing communications are high-visibility: budget 5-10 minutes for thorough review rather than treating AI output as final
- Some clients may have specific reporting requirements or preferences—ensure your prompt template captures these nuances

UC-002: Predictive Analytics

Partially suitable

Verdict

> AI can help analyse historical patterns and generate initial forecasts, but predictive accuracy is limited and requires expert validation before use in client commitments.

Department: Operations / MEP Project Delivery | **Role:** Account Director

Task Description

> *I want to predict installation timelines and potential delays by analysing our historical project data. We have data from past MEP installations and I need to use this to forecast schedules for new projects and spot likely delay patterns.*

Reasoning

AI tools like Claude can effectively analyse historical project data to identify patterns, calculate average timelines, and flag common delay factors from your past MEP installations. You can upload spreadsheets or reports containing project durations, delay causes, and contextual factors, then ask Claude to summarise trends, calculate statistics, and generate baseline forecasts.

However, predictive forecasting has significant limitations. AI cannot account for project-specific variables like site conditions, supply chain disruptions, labour availability, or client-driven changes that often cause delays in MEP work. The tool has no access to real-time data (current material lead times, subcontractor availability) and cannot incorporate domain expertise about how your specific projects differ from historical averages. Research shows AI forecasting works best for high-volume, repeatable tasks with stable conditions—construction projects rarely meet these criteria.

The'could affect client relationships' risk level is the critical concern here. Using AI-generated forecasts in client proposals or contractual commitments without thorough expert review could lead to unrealistic promises. AI might produce optimistic timelines by averaging past performance without weighting for complexity, or miss emerging risks. For client-facing schedules, this tool should only provide a starting point for your project managers to refine based on their professional judgement.

Recommended Approach

Tool: Claude Pro (claude.ai)

Method: Upload historical project data (anonymised if containing client details) and use structured prompts to extract timeline patterns, delay factors, and statistical baselines. Generate initial forecasts that your project managers then adjust based on project-specific factors.

Implementation Steps

1. **Step 1:** Prepare historical data: Create a spreadsheet with project details (type, size, duration, delays, causes). Remove or anonymise client names and sensitive commercial information before upload.
2. **Step 2:** Upload to Claude Pro and request pattern analysis: Ask Claude to identify average timelines by project type/size, most common delay causes, correlation between project characteristics and duration.
3. **Step 3:** Generate baseline forecasts: Provide details of your new project (scope, size, complexity indicators) and ask Claude to estimate timelines based on historical comparables, with confidence intervals.
4. **Step 4:** Request risk identification: Ask Claude to flag which delay factors from historical data are most likely to apply to the new project based on similarities.
5. **Step 5:** Expert review and adjustment: Have experienced project managers review Claude's analysis, applying their knowledge of current conditions, site-specific factors, and client requirements.
6. **Step 6:** Document assumptions: Record what historical data informed the forecast and what adjustments were made, creating an audit trail for client discussions.

Key Considerations

- AI forecasts lack project-specific context—supply chain conditions, labour market, site access constraints, and client behaviour patterns that experienced estimators factor in automatically.
- Historical data may not reflect current conditions—post-pandemic material lead times, labour shortages, and regulatory changes mean past performance may not predict future results.
- Client-facing commitments require professional accountability—AI-generated forecasts must be thoroughly reviewed and adjusted by competent persons (CDM 2015 requirements for construction planning).
- Sample size matters—forecasts based on fewer than 10-15 comparable projects have low statistical reliability. Claude may not flag this limitation.

- AI cannot assess project risk profiles—two similar-sized installations may have vastly different delay risks based on factors AI cannot evaluate from historical data alone.

UC-003: Financial Analysis

Partially suitable

Verdict

> AI can assist with pattern identification and preliminary analysis, but critical commercial decisions and contract compliance require human expertise and accountability.

Department: Operations / MEP Project Delivery | **Role:** Account Director

Task Description

> *I need help tracking project costs and identifying overspend risks early. I have data from our procurement and budgeting systems and need to spot when we're trending towards budget overruns, check contract compliance, and get insights to support commercial decisions.*

Reasoning

This task sits at the intersection of AI's analytical strengths and its fundamental limitations around accountability and judgement.

AI tools like Claude can effectively process project cost data to identify spending patterns, calculate variance against budgets, and flag potential overruns based on trend analysis. The daily frequency and analytical nature make this technically suitable for AI assistance. Claude's 200,000 token context window can handle substantial cost reports (approximately 400-500 pages), and it excels at summarising complex data and highlighting anomalies. For routine monitoring—spotting that materials costs are tracking 15% above forecast, or that labour hours are accelerating—AI provides genuine value.

However, the 'contract compliance' and 'commercial decision support' elements introduce serious limitations. AI cannot interpret contract clauses with legal reliability (the 2025 Ayinde case demonstrated AI fabricating legal citations), and it cannot be held accountable for compliance failures. More fundamentally, commercial decisions affecting client relationships require contextual understanding of business relationships, negotiation history, and strategic considerations that AI cannot access. The risk level ('could affect client/customer relationships') means errors could have material business consequences. AI should analyse and flag issues, but humans must verify compliance and make commercial calls.

Recommended Approach

Tool: Claude Pro

Method: Use Claude to process daily cost reports and budget data, identifying variances and trends. Create a dedicated Project with standing instructions for your analysis parameters (budget thresholds, cost categories, reporting format). Upload updated cost data daily and request variance analysis against budget baselines.

Implementation Steps

1. **Step 1:** Set up a Claude Pro account (£16/month) and create a dedicated Project called 'Project Cost Monitoring' with your standard budget categories and variance thresholds
2. **Step 2:** Anonymise any client-identifying information from cost reports before uploading (replace client names with generic codes like 'Project A', remove personal data of suppliers/contractors)
3. **Step 3:** Upload daily/weekly cost data exports (CSV, Excel, or PDF) and request variance analysis: 'Analyse this cost report against baseline budget [paste budget], flag any line items exceeding 10% variance, and identify spending trends'
4. **Step 4:** Review AI-flagged issues and verify against source systems—treat AI output as preliminary analysis requiring human confirmation
5. **Step 5:** For contract compliance questions, use AI to extract and summarise relevant clauses, but obtain qualified professional review before acting on compliance interpretations
6. **Step 6:** Document AI-assisted findings in your audit trail, noting that analysis was AI-generated and human-verified

Key Considerations

- AI cannot provide legally binding contract compliance opinions—qualified professionals must verify compliance interpretations before acting
- Commercial decisions affecting client relationships require human judgement considering relationship history, strategic context, and negotiation dynamics that AI cannot access
- AI may occasionally hallucinate figures or misinterpret complex data—all financial analysis must be verified against source systems before use
- Trend identification works best when AI has consistent data formats—irregular or changing report structures reduce accuracy

- UK GDPR requires careful handling of supplier/contractor personal data (contact details, payment information)—anonymise before AI processing or use commercial-tier plans with appropriate data processing agreements

UC-004: Compliance Checking

Probably suitable

Verdict

AI can effectively assist with compliance checking against known criteria, but requires human verification of critical findings and shouldn't replace accountability.

Department: Operations / MEP Project Delivery | **Role:** Account Director

Task Description

I need to check project documentation against compliance requirements. We have standard checklists and regulations that documents need to meet, and I spend time manually reviewing to ensure everything is in order.

Reasoning

This task is well-suited to AI's pattern recognition and analytical capabilities. Claude and similar tools excel at systematically checking documents against defined criteria, identifying gaps, and highlighting areas requiring attention. The structured nature of compliance checklists—where requirements are clearly defined—plays to AI's strengths in methodical comparison and flagging discrepancies.

However, compliance checking carries significant caveats. AI cannot be the'competent person' required by UK construction regulations (CDM 2015) or building safety legislation. It may miss nuanced regulatory interpretations, fail to flag context-dependent violations, or hallucinate compliance where gaps exist. The consequences of missed non-compliance issues—regulatory penalties, project delays, safety risks—mean human oversight is essential, not optional.

The practical value lies in AI handling the time-consuming first pass: systematically checking that required sections exist, identifying obvious gaps against your checklist, and highlighting areas needing closer review. You then focus your expertise on verifying AI findings, assessing grey areas, and taking accountability for the final compliance determination. This approach can significantly reduce manual checking time while maintaining appropriate human oversight.

Recommended Approach

Tool: Claude Pro

Method: Upload the document and your compliance checklist to Claude, then request a systematic comparison identifying gaps, missing sections, and areas of concern. Use Claude's analysis as your first pass, then conduct human verification of flagged items and overall compliance determination.

Implementation Steps

1. **Step 1:** Prepare your compliance checklist as a clear, structured document (bullet points or numbered requirements work best)
2. **Step 2:** Upload both the document requiring checking and your compliance checklist to Claude.ai
3. **Step 3:** Use the prompt template provided in claudeSummary below to request systematic checking
4. **Step 4:** Review Claude's findings critically—verify each flagged gap against the source documents yourself
5. **Step 5:** Focus your human expertise on grey areas, interpretation questions, and areas Claude flagged as unclear
6. **Step 6:** Document your final compliance determination with your professional judgement, not relying solely on AI output

Key Considerations

- AI cannot fulfil 'competent person' requirements under CDM 2015 or Building Safety Act 2022—you remain professionally accountable
- Compliance interpretations may be incorrect, especially for ambiguous regulatory language or sector-specific requirements not in AI training data
- AI may hallucinate compliance (falsely confirming requirements are met) or miss nuanced violations—verify all findings independently
- Regulatory changes post-AI training cut-off (May 2025 for Claude) won't be reflected—verify current regulation versions separately
- For legally binding compliance certifications or submissions to regulatory bodies, professional review by qualified specialists is essential
- Claude's analysis provides a useful first pass but cannot replace your professional judgement or reduce your accountability

UC-005: Communication Management

Yes, AI can help

Verdict

> Email prioritisation and sorting is well-suited to AI assistance with appropriate tool selection and setup.

Department: Estimating | **Role:** Pre Construction Director

Task Description

> *I receive dozens of emails daily related to tenders, supplier quotes, and project enquiries. I need help sorting through them, identifying what's urgent, and flagging which emails need immediate attention versus which can wait.*

Reasoning

This task aligns excellently with current AI capabilities. Email triage involves pattern recognition, content analysis, and categorisation—all strengths of modern AI tools. The frequency (daily) justifies the setup effort, and the consequence of errors (time lost, work redone) is manageable compared to higher-stakes scenarios like contractual commitments or safety-critical decisions.

Several practical approaches exist depending on your email provider and budget. SaneBox offers the most privacy-conscious option by analysing only email headers (never reading content), making it GDPR-friendly and suitable for sensitive business communications. For teams using Gmail, Shortwave provides AI-powered filtering and search. Microsoft 365 users can leverage Copilot's email summarisation features. Alternatively, you can use Claude.ai directly by periodically pasting anonymised email summaries for prioritisation advice.

The main consideration is data protection—you'll be sharing email content with third-party tools. For supplier quotes and tender-related communications, ensure you're not inputting client names, commercial terms, or personal data into free-tier AI tools. Choose services with appropriate Data Processing Agreements (DPAs) and consider whether emails contain information covered by confidentiality clauses in your contracts.

Recommended Approach

Tool: SaneBox or Shortwave

Method: Deploy an email filtering service that learns your priorities and automatically sorts incoming messages into folders (urgent, later, archive). The AI analyses patterns in your email behaviour and applies rules automatically.

Implementation Steps

1. **Step 1:** Choose your tool based on email provider: SaneBox for any provider (£7-36/month depending on accounts), Shortwave for Gmail only (free tier available, £24/month for business features)
2. **Step 2:** Set up the service by connecting your email account and granting necessary permissions—SaneBox only reads headers; Shortwave requires full email access
3. **Step 3:** Configure initial sorting rules: define what makes emails urgent (keywords like 'tender deadline', 'urgent', sender domains, specific project codes)
4. **Step 4:** Train the AI over 1-2 weeks by reviewing its sorting decisions and moving misclassified emails to correct folders—the system learns from your corrections
5. **Step 5:** Establish a daily routine: check your 'urgent' folder first thing, review the daily digest of filtered emails, and adjust rules as projects evolve
6. **Step 6:** For tender-related emails containing sensitive commercial information, verify your tool's Data Processing Agreement covers your GDPR obligations

Key Considerations

- AI email tools require 1-2 weeks of training to learn your specific priorities—initial sorting won't be perfect immediately
- Tender deadlines and urgent client requests are too important to miss—always manually check your main inbox daily even with AI filtering active
- Email tools with full content access (like Shortwave, Superhuman) create GDPR obligations—verify their Data Processing Agreement covers UK GDPR before deployment
- If your organisation has existing email security policies or DLP (Data Loss Prevention) systems, check with IT before connecting third-party tools
- Costs add up: SaneBox at £36/month for multiple accounts, or Shortwave at £24/user/month for teams—budget accordingly

UC-006: Data Analysis

Probably suitable

Verdict

> AI can effectively analyse cost trends and identify patterns, but data preparation and verification of findings are critical requirements.

Department: Estimating | **Role:** Pre Construction Director

Task Description

> *I need to analyse historical cost data to identify pricing trends. We have years of project cost data and I want to spot patterns in material costs, labour rates, and how prices change over time to improve our estimates.*

Reasoning

This task aligns well with AI's pattern recognition capabilities—Claude can process years of cost data, identify trends, flag anomalies, and generate insights about pricing movements. The analytical nature of the work (spotting correlations between material costs, labour rates, and time periods) suits AI strengths.

However, several factors require caution. First, your historical data likely contains sensitive commercial information (supplier pricing, project costs, client details) that requires careful anonymisation before AI processing. Second, AI may identify statistical correlations that aren't causally meaningful—construction cost fluctuations involve complex market factors, seasonal variations, and regional differences that require industry expertise to interpret correctly. Third, the accuracy of AI analysis depends heavily on consistent data formatting across years; if your cost data structure has changed over time or contains inconsistencies, significant data cleaning work will be needed first.

The weekly frequency suggests this is business-critical work where errors could compound over time, leading to systematic estimating problems. While AI can accelerate the analysis dramatically compared to manual spreadsheet work, you'll need robust verification processes—comparing AI-identified trends against known market events, cross-referencing with industry benchmarks, and validating unusual findings with experienced estimators.

Recommended Approach

Tool: Claude.ai Pro

Method: Upload anonymised cost data extracts to Claude and use structured prompts to request trend analysis, pattern identification, and visualisation suggestions. Export findings to your estimating systems for validation.

Implementation Steps

1. **Step 1:** Prepare your data: Export cost data to CSV or Excel format, anonymise client/supplier names, and ensure consistent formatting (same column headers, date formats, currency units across all years)
2. **Step 2:** Upload a sample dataset first: Test with 6-12 months of data to verify Claude interprets your cost categories correctly before processing years of information
3. **Step 3:** Request structured analysis: Ask Claude to identify trends by category (materials vs labour), flag unusual price movements exceeding certain thresholds, and compare year-on-year changes
4. **Step 4:** Validate key findings: Cross-reference AI-identified trends against known market events (Brexit impact 2016-2020, COVID supply chain disruptions 2020-2021, steel price volatility) to check plausibility
5. **Step 5:** Create analysis templates: Save effective prompts as templates for weekly updates, allowing consistent analysis methodology over time
6. **Step 6:** Export insights to your estimating system: Use Claude's findings to update pricing assumptions, adjust contingency factors, and brief your estimating team on relevant trends

Key Considerations

- Data preparation is substantial: Cleaning and standardising years of cost data may take longer than the actual AI analysis—budget time for this essential step
- AI cannot replace estimating expertise: Claude can identify 'material costs increased 15% in Q3 2023' but cannot judge whether this reflects temporary supply shocks or permanent market shifts—you need industry knowledge to interpret
- Statistical correlations aren't causal relationships: AI may identify patterns that are coincidental rather than meaningful—validate findings against your understanding of construction economics
- Regional variations matter: UK construction costs vary significantly by region—ensure your prompts specify geographic context if your data spans multiple locations

- Historical data has limited predictive value: Cost trends from 2019-2024 won't necessarily predict 2025-2026 given current economic uncertainty—use AI for understanding past patterns, not automatic forecasting

UC-007: Report Generation

Probably suitable

Verdict

> AI can help draft these reports and analyse trends, but requires proper data preparation and human verification of calculations.

Department: Estimating | **Role:** Pre Construction Director

Task Description

> *I need to produce monthly reports on estimating team activity - how many tenders we've submitted, win rates, average margins, and workload distribution. The data comes from our tracking spreadsheets.*

Reasoning

This task is well-suited to AI assistance because it involves transforming structured data into narrative reports—a core AI strength. Claude can analyse spreadsheet data, calculate key metrics like win rates and margins, identify trends over time, and generate professional prose summaries.

However, the "probably" rather than "yes" rating reflects two important considerations. First, AI can make calculation errors with numerical data (the documented hallucination risk), so all figures must be independently verified before distribution. Second, the effectiveness depends heavily on how cleanly your tracking spreadsheets are structured—messy or inconsistent data will produce unreliable outputs.

The risk level is appropriate: these are internal reports where errors would be caught during review, and corrections are straightforward. For monthly reporting, the time savings from AI-assisted drafting (converting raw data to polished narrative) will likely be significant once you establish a reliable workflow.

Recommended Approach

Tool: Claude.ai (Pro recommended for regular use)

Method: Upload your tracking spreadsheet to Claude and provide a clear prompt specifying which metrics to calculate and how to structure the report. Use a consistent prompt template each month for reproducible results.

Implementation Steps

1. **Step 1:** Step 1: Clean your tracking spreadsheet—ensure consistent column headers, remove blank rows, and verify data completeness before upload
2. **Step 2:** Step 2: Upload the Excel/CSV file to Claude.ai and paste your report template prompt (see example in Getting Started guide)
3. **Step 3:** Step 3: Review Claude's output carefully—independently verify all calculated figures (win rates, margins, percentages) against your source data
4. **Step 4:** Step 4: Copy the verified text into your report template, add any company-specific context Claude wouldn't know, and finalise formatting
5. **Step 5:** Step 5: Save your successful prompt as a template for next month—you'll only need to swap the data file and update the reporting period

Key Considerations

- AI can make arithmetic errors—always independently verify calculations like win rates, averages, and percentages before distributing reports
- Claude cannot access your spreadsheet formulas or hidden data—ensure all relevant information is visible in the uploaded file
- Trends and insights AI identifies are based solely on the data provided—it cannot know about external factors (market conditions, team changes) that may explain patterns
- First-time setup requires effort to create a good prompt template, but monthly repetition becomes quick once established
- If your tracking data is inconsistent month-to-month (changing column names, different layouts), results will be unreliable—standardise your data capture first

UC-008: Quantity Surveying

Not recommended

Verdict

Current AI tools cannot reliably perform quantity take-offs from construction drawings—this requires specialist software or professional surveyor expertise.

Department: Estimating | **Role:** Pre Construction Director

Task Description

I need to do quantity take-offs from construction drawings - measuring cable runs, counting sockets, calculating duct lengths. It's time-consuming manual work going through each drawing and extracting quantities for pricing.

Reasoning

Quantity take-offs from construction drawings require precise spatial understanding, scale interpretation, and accurate measurement extraction that current general-purpose AI tools (including Claude) fundamentally cannot perform reliably. While Claude can read PDF drawings and identify text elements, it cannot:

1) Accurately measure distances, areas, or volumes from scaled drawings
2) Trace cable routes through complex floor plans with precision
3) Count physical elements like sockets with the spatial accuracy required for costing
4) Distinguish between different drawing layers or understand construction symbology consistently

This isn't a limitation that better prompting can overcome—it's a fundamental capability gap. AI image recognition excels at identifying objects in photographs but struggles with technical drawings where scale, precision, and spatial relationships are critical. A2% measurement error might sound small, but on a £500,000 electrical contract, that's a £10,000 pricing error that could cost you the job or your profit margin.

The risk level you've identified ("could affect client/customer relationships") is exactly right, and the consequences of inaccurate take-offs are severe: underpricing loses money, overpricing loses tenders, and both damage professional credibility. This task requires either specialist quantity surveying software (CostX, Bluebeam Revu, PlanSwift) that's purpose-built for this work, or a qualified quantity surveyor who can verify measurements and apply professional judgement.

Recommended Approach

Tool: Specialist quantity surveying software (CostX, Bluebeam Revu, PlanSwift) or professional QS

Method: Use dedicated quantity surveying software that allows you to calibrate drawing scales, digitally measure lengths and areas, and automatically count symbols. For occasional needs or complex projects, engage a professional quantity surveyor.

Implementation Steps

1. **Step 1:** For regular take-off work: Invest in specialist software like Bluebeam Revu (from £180/year), PlanSwift, or CostX which provide calibrated measurement tools designed for construction drawings
2. **Step 2:** Import your PDF drawings into the software and calibrate the scale using known dimensions on the drawing
3. **Step 3:** Use the software's measurement tools to trace cable runs, count sockets (with symbol recognition), and calculate duct lengths with precision
4. **Step 4:** Export quantities directly to Excel or your estimating system for pricing
5. **Step 5:** For occasional or complex projects: Consider outsourcing to a professional quantity surveyor who can guarantee accuracy and provide professional indemnity insurance coverage
6. **Step 6:** Establish a quality checking process: verify measurements against known dimensions or have a second person spot-check critical quantities

Key Considerations

- General AI tools like Claude cannot accurately measure from drawings—they can read text and identify shapes but cannot perform precise scaled measurements
- Quantity take-off errors directly impact profitability and competitive positioning—this is not a low-stakes task suitable for experimentation with emerging AI
- Professional quantity surveying software typically costs £180-£1,200annually for SMB-appropriate solutions—significantly less than the cost of pricing errors
- If you need AI assistance, it's better suited to helping you write clearer descriptions of measured items or organising your take-off schedule—not the measurement itself
- For very simple counts (e.g., 'count the red circles on this diagram'), AI might help, but construction drawings involve scaled measurements and technical interpretation beyond current AI capabilities

UC-009: Document Summarisation

Yes, AI can help

Verdict

> AI is highly suitable for extracting and summarising key requirements from lengthy specifications, significantly reducing reading time whilst enabling thorough analysis.

Department: Estimating | **Role:** Pre Construction Director

Task Description

> *I need to read through lengthy project specifications (often 100+ pages) and extract the key requirements relevant to our electrical scope - what standards apply, specific product requirements, testing needs, and any unusual conditions.*

Reasoning

This task is extremely well-suited to AI capabilities. Claude can handle documents up to 200,000 tokens (approximately 400-500 pages), making 100+ page specifications entirely manageable within a single conversation. AI excels at structured information extraction—identifying standards references (BS 7671, IEC specifications), product requirements, testing protocols, and unusual conditions.

The risk profile is appropriate for AI assistance. While the consequence of missing a requirement is rework and time lost (not safety-critical or financially catastrophic), AI's systematic approach actually reduces this risk compared to manual scanning. You maintain control by reviewing AI's extracted summaries against the source document, and any ambiguities can be clarified through follow-up questions. The electrical scope focus means you bring domain expertise to validate AI's findings.

For UK engineering firms, this represents a high-value AI use case: transforming hours of manual document review into 15-30 minutes of AI-assisted extraction plus validation time. The ad-hoc frequency makes a straightforward Claude Pro subscription (£16/month) more economical than building custom automation.

Recommended Approach

Tool: Claude.ai (Pro recommended)

Method: Upload specification PDFs directly to Claude and use structured prompts requesting extraction of electrical scope requirements organised by category (standards, products, testing, conditions). Follow up with clarifying questions on any unclear items.

Implementation Steps

1. **Step 1:** Upload the specification PDF to Claude.ai (supports files up to 30MB, 20 files per conversation)
2. **Step 2:** Use a structured prompt requesting extraction of: applicable standards (BS/IEC/etc.), specific product requirements, testing/commissioning needs, and unusual conditions relevant to electrical scope
3. **Step 3:** Review Claude's extracted summary for completeness and accuracy, cross-referencing key items against the source document
4. **Step 4:** Ask follow-up questions to clarify ambiguous requirements or request page references for critical specifications
5. **Step 5:** Export the organised requirements list and integrate into your scope document or estimate template
6. **Step 6:** Create a reusable prompt template based on what works well, saving it for future specification reviews

Key Considerations

- AI may occasionally misinterpret technical specifications or miss nuanced requirements—always validate critical standards references and product specifications against the source document
- Complex electrical calculations, load schedules, or circuit designs mentioned in specifications require human engineering review—AI can highlight them but not verify technical accuracy
- Cross-document references (e.g.,'refer to Specification Section 3.2.1' pointing to another document) won't be resolved unless you upload all referenced documents together
- Scanned PDF specifications with poor OCR quality may produce incomplete extractions—test with a short section first to verify text recognition quality
- For GDPR compliance, avoid uploading specifications containing personal data (employee details, homeowner information) to free-tier accounts; use paid plans with training disabled or anonymise first

UC-010: Administrative Automation

Not recommended

Verdict

This task requires workflow automation tools rather than generative AI—while Claude can work with Excel files, event-triggered automation needs dedicated workflow tools.

Department: Admin/Office | **Role:** PA/Office Manager

Task Description

When staff submit holiday requests, I need to update both the team spreadsheet and their Outlook calendar. I'd like this to happen automatically instead of me manually entering the same information twice.

Reasoning

While Claude can now work directly with Excel files (through uploads or the Excel add-in for Max/Team/Enterprise users), and calendar integrations are possible through MCP connections, this specific task requires event-triggered automation—when a holiday request is submitted, automatically update both systems. Workflow automation tools like Power Automate or Zapier are specifically designed for these event-driven integrations and remain the most appropriate solution.

The good news: this is an excellent candidate for traditional automation tools like Microsoft Power Automate (included with many Microsoft 365 subscriptions), Zapier, or Make. These tools specialise in connecting different systems and performing actions automatically when triggered by events—exactly what you need. They can monitor for holiday request submissions (via email, form, or other trigger), then update both your spreadsheet and Outlook calendar without any manual intervention.

While AI isn't the answer here, this type of automation often delivers excellent ROI for SMBs because it eliminates repetitive data entry completely. A basic automation workflow like this is achievable even for non-technical users, typically taking 1-2 hours to set up initially.

Recommended Approach

Tool: Microsoft Power Automate or Zapier

Method: Set up an automated workflow that triggers when a holiday request is submitted (via email or form), then automatically updates both the Excel spreadsheet and creates/updates Outlook calendar entries.

Implementation Steps

1. **Step 1:** Choose your automation platform: Microsoft Power Automate if you have Microsoft 365 Business Standard or Premium (included); otherwise Zapier (free tier may suffice)
2. **Step 2:** Set up the trigger: Create a form (Microsoft Forms, Google Forms, or Zapier Forms) for staff to submit holiday requests with fields for name, dates, and type of leave
3. **Step 3:** Configure the first action: Connect to your Excel spreadsheet (OneDrive or SharePoint) and set up a'Add row to table' action that populates with the form submission data
4. **Step 4:** Configure the second action: Connect to Outlook Calendar and create a'Create event' action using the same form data, setting the event title, dates, and marking as 'Out of Office'
5. **Step 5:** Test the workflow: Submit a test holiday request and verify both the spreadsheet and calendar update correctly
6. **Step 6:** Document the process: Create a brief guide for staff showing how to submit requests through the new form rather than emailing you directly

Key Considerations

- This requires a one-time setup investment of 1-3 hours but saves significant time long-term—worth the initial effort for recurring tasks
- Staff will need to use a form rather than free-form emails, which requires brief training and communication about the process change
- Consider what happens to existing holiday bookings—you may need to manually migrate these into the new system initially
- Ensure your Excel spreadsheet is formatted as a proper Table (Insert > Table) as automation tools work better with structured data
- If you don't have Microsoft 365 with Power Automate included, Zapier's free tier allows 100 tasks/month which may suffice for a small team

UC-011: Communication Automation

Yes, AI can help

Verdict

AI is highly suitable for drafting supply chain emails from templates, saving significant time on routine communications.

Department: Admin/Office | **Role:** PA/Office Manager

Task Description

I need to send regular emails to our supply chain - order confirmations, delivery chase-ups, and status updates. I'd like help drafting these emails quickly using standard templates but customised for each supplier and order.

Reasoning

This task aligns excellently with AI capabilities. Email drafting from templates is one of AI's strongest use cases—it excels at maintaining consistent tone whilst customising content based on specific details. The task involves repetitive structure (confirmations, chase-ups, status updates) with variable content (supplier names, order details, dates), which is precisely where AI provides maximum value.

The risk level is appropriate for AI assistance. Email drafting errors are easily caught during review, and the consequences (needing to send a correction) are manageable rather than severe. You maintain full control by reviewing before sending. The weekly frequency justifies the setup effort—creating effective prompts and templates will pay dividends across multiple uses.

For UK SMBs, the main consideration is data protection. Supply chain emails typically contain commercial information (order numbers, quantities, delivery dates) rather than personal data, making them lower-risk for AI processing. However, you should avoid including sensitive pricing, contract terms, or supplier confidential information in prompts to free-tier AI tools. Claude Pro (£16/month) or ChatGPT Team (£20/user/month) provide better data protection through commercial terms.

Recommended Approach

Tool: Claude Pro

Method: Create reusable prompt templates for each email type (confirmation, chase-up, status update) that you customise with specific order details. Build a library of effective prompts in Claude's Projects feature for quick access.

Implementation Steps

1. **Step 1:** Set up Claude Pro account (£16/month) and configure preferences for 'professional UK business tone, concise and direct'
2. **Step 2:** Create three master prompt templates—one each for order confirmations, delivery chase-ups, and status updates—based on your existing email patterns
3. **Step 3:** For each email session, paste your template and add specific details: supplier name, order reference, items/quantities, dates, and any special context
4. **Step 4:** Review Claude's draft for accuracy (verify all figures, dates, and names), adjust tone if needed, then copy to your email client
5. **Step 5:** Save your best-performing prompts in a Claude Project called 'Supply Chain Emails' for instant reuse
6. **Step 6:** After 2-3 weeks, refine your templates based on what works—note which prompts need least editing

Key Considerations

- Always verify order numbers, quantities, dates, and supplier names before sending—AI can occasionally transpose details
- Establish a review habit: read each draft completely rather than skimming, as AI-generated text can sound plausible even when incorrect
- Keep a 'swipe file' of your actual sent emails to show Claude your preferred style and terminology
- Start with lower-stakes emails (routine status updates) before using AI for time-sensitive chase-ups or complex situations
- Your suppliers may eventually recognise AI-generated patterns—add personal touches or specific references to maintain relationship warmth

UC-012: Workflow Automation

Partially suitable

Verdict

AI can draft reminder emails but traditional automation tools are better suited for the tracking and triggering aspects of this task.

Department: Admin/Office | **Role:** PA/Office Manager

Task Description

I track employee clearances and need to send reminder emails when someone hasn't completed their clearance after a certain number of days. Currently I check this manually each week.

Reasoning

This task splits into two distinct components: tracking clearance status and sending reminder emails. The tracking component—monitoring a spreadsheet, identifying overdue items, and triggering actions—is precisely what traditional automation tools like Zapier or Microsoft Power Automate excel at. These tools provide reliable, rule-based automation at lower cost than AI solutions, with better auditability for compliance tracking.

AI becomes useful for the email drafting aspect, particularly if reminder messages need personalisation beyond simple mail merge (adjusting tone based on how overdue someone is, varying the message by clearance type, etc.). Claude or similar tools can generate professional, appropriately worded reminder templates. However, the core workflow—checking dates and triggering actions—doesn't require AI's interpretive capabilities.

The'ad-hoc' frequency you've mentioned suggests this happens irregularly rather than weekly, which is unusual for a compliance tracking task. If these reminders truly need to go out on a schedule (weekly, fortnightly), automation is definitely the right approach. If'ad-hoc' means you're manually deciding when to chase people, that indicates a process improvement opportunity beyond just AI assistance.

Recommended Approach

Tool: Microsoft Power Automate (if using Microsoft 365) or Zapier

Method: Set up an automated workflow that checks your clearance spreadsheet daily, identifies overdue items, and sends templated reminder emails automatically. Use AI (Claude) separately to create well-worded email templates for different scenarios.

Implementation Steps

1. **Step 1:** Organise your clearance tracking spreadsheet with clear columns: Employee Name, Clearance Type, Start Date, Days Elapsed, Status, Email Address
2. **Step 2:** Create email templates for different scenarios (e.g., 7 days overdue, 14 days overdue, 30 days overdue) using Claude to draft professional wording
3. **Step 3:** Set up a Power Automate flow (if using Microsoft 365) or Zapier automation to check your spreadsheet daily for rows where Days Elapsed exceeds your threshold and Status = 'Incomplete'
4. **Step 4:** Configure the automation to send the appropriate email template to each overdue employee, with personalised fields (name, clearance type, days overdue) inserted automatically
5. **Step 5:** Add a step to log sent reminders back to your spreadsheet (e.g.,'Last Reminder Sent' column) to prevent duplicate emails
6. **Step 6:** Test with a dummy entry first, then monitor for the first week to catch any configuration issues

Key Considerations

- Traditional automation (Power Automate, Zapier) is more reliable and cost-effective for this specific task than AI-based solutions
- Employee data is personal information under UK GDPR—ensure any automation tool has appropriate data processing agreements
- Consider whether'ad-hoc' frequency is actually the right approach for compliance tracking—scheduled automated checks may be more appropriate
- If clearance tracking has compliance or regulatory implications (security clearances, professional certifications), maintain an audit trail of all reminders sent
- Test automation carefully before full deployment to avoid sending incorrect or duplicate reminders to staff

UC-013: Compliance Monitoring

Not recommended

Verdict

This tracking and alerting task requires automated monitoring and notifications that traditional calendar/spreadsheet tools handle better than generative AI.

Department: Admin/Office | **Role:** PA/Office Manager

Task Description

I manage our Construction Line accreditation and various certifications. I need to track expiry dates and get alerts when things are about to expire so we can renew in time and stay compliant.

Reasoning

Generative AI (like Claude, ChatGPT) is fundamentally designed for conversational tasks—analysing documents, generating text, answering questions. It cannot autonomously monitor dates, send alerts, or track compliance status over time. You'd need to manually ask the AI to check your documents every day, which defeats the purpose of automation.

What you actually need is a tracking system with automated reminders—something that continuously monitors dates and proactively alerts you. Options include: (1) a simple Excel/Google Sheets spreadsheet with conditional formatting and manual calendar reminders, (2) dedicated compliance tracking software, or (3) a project management tool with deadline notifications (Trello, Asana, Monday.com).

AI *could* help you initially by extracting certification details and expiry dates from PDF documents to populate your tracking system, but the ongoing monitoring and alerting functionality must come from traditional tools. The'daily' frequency and need for automatic alerts are the key indicators that this isn't an AI task—it's a database/calendar task with notification requirements.

Recommended Approach

Tool: Excel/Google Sheets with calendar integration or dedicated compliance software

Method: Create a centralised tracking spreadsheet with certification names, expiry dates, renewal lead times, and responsible persons. Set up conditional formatting to highlight upcoming renewals and integrate with calendar reminders or use dedicated compliance software if budget allows.

Implementation Steps

1. **Step 1:** Create a master spreadsheet listing all certifications: Construction Line, ISO certifications, insurance policies, professional memberships, health & safety accreditations
2. **Step 2:** For each certification, record: certificate name, issuing body, current expiry date, renewal lead time (e.g., 90 days), person responsible, and last renewal date
3. **Step 3:** Add a calculated column showing 'days until expiry' using TODAY() function, and apply conditional formatting (red<30 days, amber<60 days, green >60 days)
4. **Step 4:** Set up calendar reminders or recurring tasks in your project management system at appropriate intervals (90 days, 60 days, 30 days before expiry)
5. **Step 5:** Consider dedicated compliance tracking software like Cognibox, Alcumus, or ComplianceQuest if managing multiple certifications across larger teams
6. **Step 6:** Review the tracker weekly and update immediately when renewals are completed

Key Considerations

- Generative AI cannot run autonomously—you must actively prompt it each time, making daily checks impractical
- AI could assist with the initial setup by extracting dates from certification PDFs, but this is a one-time task, not ongoing monitoring
- Free tools (Google Sheets, Excel + Outlook) can achieve 90% of what you need without additional costs
- If managing certifications for multiple sites or large teams, dedicated compliance software (£500-2,000/year) may justify the cost through better audit trails and automated workflows
- Consider whether your construction management software (Procore, Viewpoint) already includes compliance tracking modules before purchasing standalone tools

UC-014: Bid Writing

Yes, AI can help

Verdict

> AI is highly suitable for managing PQQ responses - it can effectively search previous answers, adapt content to new questions, and ensure consistency across submissions.

Department: Admin/Office | **Role:** PA/Office Manager

Task Description

> *I complete pre-qualification questionnaires (PQQs) for tenders. Many questions are similar across different PQQs - about our health and safety policies, insurance, accreditations, etc. I want help finding and adapting our previous answers to fit new questions.*

Reasoning

This task is an excellent fit for generative AI capabilities. Pre-qualification questionnaires aredocument-heavy, involve significant repetition, and require tailoring standard information to specific question formats - all activities where AI excels.

AI tools like Claude can analyse your library of previous PQQ submissions, identify relevant passages that answer new questions, and adapt the language to match the specific requirements of each tender. This addresses the core inefficiency in PQQ completion: repeatedly searching through old documents to find where you've answered similar questions before. The task involves primarily text processing and pattern matching between question types, which are AI strengths.

The risk level is appropriate for AI assistance with proper human oversight. While PQQsdo affect client relationships, errors are typically catchable through review before submission. The information involved (company policies, insurance details, accreditations) is factual and verifiable, reducing the likelihood of AI hallucination. However, given that PQQs often contain commercially sensitive information and the outputs directly represent your company to potential clients, human verification of all AI-generated content is essential before submission.

Recommended Approach

Tool: Claude.ai (Pro recommended)

Method: Create a structured library of previous PQQ answers organised by topic (health & safety, insurance, accreditations, experience, etc.). When facing a new PQQ, upload relevant previous submissions to Claude along with the new questionnaire, then prompt it to identify matching questions and adapt your established answers to the new format and specific requirements.

Implementation Steps

1. **Step 1:** Organise your previous PQQ submissions into a reference library, ideally grouping standard answers by topic (health & safety policies, insurance levels, quality accreditations, key projects, financial information, environmental policies, etc.)
2. **Step 2:** When you receive a new PQQ, review it to identify which topics are covered and select 2-3 of your most comprehensive previous submissions that address similar areas
3. **Step 3:** Upload the new PQQ and your selected previous submissions to Claude.ai, then use a structured prompt asking Claude to: (a) identify which new questions match your previous answers, (b) extract the relevant passages, and (c) adapt them to the new question's specific wording and format requirements
4. **Step 4:** Review Claude's suggested answers critically, verifying all factual claims (dates, figures, accreditations, insurance levels) against your current documentation, as these may have changed since previous submissions
5. **Step 5:** Refine any answers that need updating or stronger alignment with the specific tender requirements, using Claude iteratively to improve language and ensure you've addressed all aspects of multi-part questions
6. **Step 6:** Maintain a'master answer bank'document with your best responses to common PQQ topics, updating it after each successful tender - this creates an increasingly effective reference library for future use

Key Considerations

- AI may occasionally misunderstand the subtle differences between similar-sounding questions and suggest answers that don't quite fit the specific requirement being asked
- Factual information (insurance levels, accreditation dates, financial figures, project completion dates) must be manually verified against current records as AI cannot know if these have changed since your previous submissions

- Each tender may have specific requirements about answer format (word limits, mandatory sub-sections, required evidence) that AI might miss - always check the PQQ instructions carefully
- Some questions require strategic decisions about what to emphasise or how to position your company - AI can draft content but cannot make these strategic judgements for you
- If your PQQs routinely contain the same client names or highly confidential project details, consider whether the time saved justifies the data handling considerations, or whether a more manual approach with AI for non-sensitive sections would be more appropriate

UC-015: Document Creation

Yes, AI can help

Verdict

> AI transcription and summarisation tools are highly effective for converting meeting recordings and notes into structured minutes, offering significant time savings with proper review.

Department: Admin/Office | **Role:** PA/Office Manager

Task Description

> *After meetings, I need to write up the minutes including key discussion points, decisions made, and action items with owners. I have my handwritten notes and sometimes a recording.*

Reasoning

This task is exceptionally well-suited to AI assistance and represents one of the most mature use cases for generative AI in business settings. Meeting transcription tools like Otter.ai, Fireflies, and tl;dv have been specifically designed for this purpose, achieving high accuracy rates for speaker identification, action item extraction, and decision tracking.

The risk profile is low-to-moderate: while incorrect minutes could cause confusion, the consequences are primarily time-based rather than financial or legal. The task involves internal information rather than sensitive client data, and you maintain control through review before distribution. The frequency (ad-hoc) makes this ideal for AI—you avoid the overhead of manual minutes without needing complex automation setup.

Both pathways work well: recording-based transcription (Otter.ai, Fireflies) for automatic capture, or using Claude.ai to structure your handwritten notes. The combination of both—recording for accuracy plus your notes for context—gives the best results. UK GDPR requires participant consent for recording, but this is straightforward to implement with a standard meeting notice.

Recommended Approach

Tool: Otter.ai or tl;dv (for recording) + Claude.ai (for notes)

Method: Set up automatic meeting transcription using a tool like Otter.ai (free tier provides 300 minutes/month) or tl;dv (unlimited free recording with EU hosting). For meetings where recording isn't possible, upload your handwritten notes or paste them into Claude.ai to generate structured minutes. Always review the output for accuracy before distribution.

Implementation Steps

1. **Step 1:** For recorded meetings: Sign up for Otter.ai (free tier) or tl;dv and connect it to your calendar. The tool will automatically join meetings and transcribe in real-time.
2. **Step 2:** Add a standard line to meeting invites:'This meeting will be recorded and transcribed for minute-taking purposes' to satisfy GDPR consent requirements.
3. **Step 3:** After the meeting, review the auto-generated transcript and use the tool's summary feature to extract key points, decisions, and action items.
4. **Step 4:** For handwritten notes: Open Claude.ai and use the meeting minutes prompt template from the getting-started guide, pasting your rough notes into the transcript section.
5. **Step 5:** Review the generated minutes carefully—verify all action items have correct owners, decisions are accurately captured, and no important context was missed.
6. **Step 6:** Customise the format to match your organisation's standard template, then distribute to attendees.

Key Considerations

- Participant consent is legally required under UK GDPR—always inform attendees that meetings will be recorded and transcribed before starting the recording
- Audio quality directly affects transcription accuracy—encourage participants to use quality microphones and minimise background noise
- Technical jargon, acronyms, and industry-specific terms may be misheard—review these sections carefully and add custom vocabulary to your transcription tool where possible
- Speaker identification can struggle with similar voices or multiple people talking over each other—budget time to correct speaker labels
- AI-generated minutes require human review before distribution—you remain accountable for accuracy even when AI assists with drafting

UC-016: Document Control

Partially suitable

Verdict

AI can assist with parts of this task, but drawing register maintenance requires structured automation rather than conversational AI for reliability and accuracy.

Department: Admin/Office | **Role:** PA/Office Manager

Task Description

I maintain drawing registers for projects - logging each drawing, its revision, date received, and status. When new drawings come in, I need to update the register and check if they supersede existing versions. It's tedious and easy to make mistakes.

Reasoning

Drawing register maintenance involves two distinct challenges: data entry (logging drawing details) and version control logic (determining if new drawings supersede existing ones). While Claude can now work directly with Excel files (through uploads, the Excel add-in for Max/Team/Enterprise users, or Claude Code for technical users), and can help with both parts of this task, the daily repetitive nature of drawing register maintenance means you would benefit more from dedicated automation that runs continuously without manual intervention.

The core issue is that this task happens daily and requires systematic processing rather than ad-hoc analysis. While you could manually upload your register to Claude each time new drawings arrive and ask it to identify conflicts, this creates a bottleneck and doesn't solve the data entry problem. The real value would come from automating the workflow: extracting drawing metadata from PDFs, matching against your register, and flagging superseded versions automatically.

The risk level—affecting client relationships—means errors in version control could be serious. Manual transcription errors when moving between Claude's suggestions and your spreadsheet introduce exactly the kind of mistakes you're trying to avoid. For daily, mission-critical tasks like this, structured automation tools (combining OCR for PDF metadata extraction with spreadsheet automation) would deliver better reliability than conversational AI.

Recommended Approach

Tool: Claude Pro (with Power Query or Zapier for full automation)

Method: Use Claude to establish version control logic and analyse drawing batches, then implement structured automation for daily operations. For immediate help, Claude can audit your current register and suggest improvements to your process.

Implementation Steps

1. **Step 1:** Export your current drawing register to CSV or paste into Claude to analyse the existing structure and identify any version conflicts or inconsistencies
2. **Step 2:** Ask Claude to help create a version numbering logicdocument (e.g., how drawing numbers increment, what constitutes a superseding revision) specific to your projects
3. **Step 3:** For daily updates: paste new drawing details into Claude and ask it to identify which existing drawings they supersede based on your established logic
4. **Step 4:** Manually update your spreadsheet based on Claude's analysis, implementing a clear workflow (e.g., colour-code superseded drawings before archiving)
5. **Step 5:** For long-term efficiency: explore Power Query (built into Excel) to automate drawing number parsing, or use Zapier/Make to connect document management systems with your register
6. **Step 6:** Consider upgrading to a properdocument control system (e.g., Procore, Asite, BIM 360) if drawing volume justifies it—these handle version control automatically

Key Considerations

- While Claude can work with Excel files through uploads or add-ins, daily repetitive workflows benefit from dedicated automation that runs continuously without manual prompting
- Drawing number conventions vary by discipline and organisation; Claude needs clear examples of your specific numbering system to make accurate supersession judgements
- For daily, repetitive tasks, the manual upload-analyse-transcribe cycle becomes a bottleneck; automation tools would be more efficient long-term
- If drawings arrive as PDFs with metadata, OCR-based extraction tools (Adobe Acrobat, ABBYY) could feed automation workflows more reliably than manual entry
- Version control errors could have serious consequences (contractors working from superseded drawings); human verification of Claude's recommendations is essential

UC-017: Meeting Automation

Yes, AI can help

Verdict

AI transcription tools are highly suitable for this task and can dramatically reduce the time spent on meeting summaries.

Department: Admin/Office | **Role:** PA/Office Manager

Task Description

I record team meetings and then need to transcribe them and send a summary to everyone who attended. The transcription and summary writing takes ages.

Reasoning

Meeting transcription and summarisation is one of AI's strongest use cases, with mature, reliable tools available specifically designed for this purpose. Modern AI transcription services like Otter.ai, Fireflies, and tl;dv achieve professional-grade accuracy and can automatically generate summaries, action items, and speaker identification in real-time. For UK SMBs, this task presents low risk—if the AI misses something in the summary, attendees can catch it, and the stakes are typically not critical.

The main considerations are GDPR compliance (requiring participant consent for recording) and data handling (ensuring internal meeting content isn't used to train AI models). For internal team meetings with non-sensitive content, free tiers of transcription tools work well. For client-facing or confidential meetings, paid tiers with data processing agreements are essential. The time savings are substantial—what currently takes you significant time for transcription and summary writing can be reduced to 5-10 minutes of review and light editing.

Your specific workflow (ad-hoc meetings requiring transcription and summary distribution) perfectly matches what these tools are designed for. The'requires redoing work, time lost' risk level is actually quite low for this application—meeting summaries are collaborative documents where errors are easily caught and corrected by attendees.

Recommended Approach

Tool: Otter.ai (or tl;dv for stronger GDPR compliance)

Method: Use a meeting transcription service that automatically joins calls, transcribes in real-time, and generates summaries. Review and refine the AI-generated summary, then distribute to attendees.

Implementation Steps

1. **Step 1:** Choose and set up a transcription tool: Otter.ai (free tier: 300 min/month) for ease of use, or tl;dv (free tier: unlimited recordings) for EU data hosting if GDPR compliance is a priority
2. **Step 2:** Connect the tool to your calendar and enable automatic meeting capture—the bot will join your video calls automatically
3. **Step 3:** Add a standard consent notice to your meeting invites (required under UK GDPR):'This meeting will be recorded and transcribed for note-taking purposes'
4. **Step 4:** After each meeting, review the auto-generated transcript for any misheard technical terms or speaker misidentifications
5. **Step 5:** Use the AI summary feature to generate key points and action items, then edit for accuracy and clarity (typically 5-10 minutes)
6. **Step 6:** Export the finalised summary and share via email or your project management system

Key Considerations

- Audio quality directly affects transcription accuracy—encourage participants to use headsets and minimise background noise
- Speaker identification can struggle with similar-sounding voices—always review speaker labels before distributing summaries
- Technical jargon, acronyms, and company-specific terminology may be misheard initially—most tools allow you to add custom vocabulary
- Free tiers may have data retention policies that use your content for model training unless you opt out—check settings or upgrade to paid plans for business use
- The AI-generated summary is a starting point, not a final product—always review for accuracy and completeness before sharing

UC-018: Task Management

Yes, AI can help

Verdict

> AI is well-suited for extracting action items from meeting notes and structuring them into trackable task lists—this is a core strength of current AI tools.

Department: Admin/Office | **Role:** PA/Office Manager

Task Description

> *After project meetings or when planning work, I need to create a list of tasks that the admin team can share and work through together. I want to extract action items from meeting notes and turn them into a trackable task list.*

Reasoning

This task aligns excellently with AI capabilities. Extracting action items, identifying responsible parties, noting deadlines, and structuring information into consistent formats are tasks where AI performs reliably. The daily frequency makes AI assistance particularly valuable for time savings, and the low-risk nature (minor inconvenience if errors occur) means human review can catch any mistakes before they cause problems.

The task characteristics are ideal: well-defined output format (task lists), pattern recognition (identifying action items within notes), and text processing (converting unstructured meeting notes into structured data). Since this involves internal documents rather than client-facing or highly sensitive material, data handling concerns are manageable with appropriate tool selection.

The main consideration is ensuring consistent output formatting so your team can easily work with the results. AI can be trained through prompts to match your preferred task list structure (columns for task description, owner, deadline, status, etc.), making the output immediately usable in your team's workflow.

Recommended Approach

Tool: Claude.ai (Pro recommended for daily use)

Method: Upload meeting notes or paste text into Claude, use a structured prompt template to extract action items, and request output in your preferred format (table, CSV, or bullet list). Save effective prompts for reuse to maintain consistency.

Implementation Steps

1. **Step 1:** Gather your meeting notes immediately after meetings (Word docs, PDFs, or typed notes)
2. **Step 2:** Open Claude.ai and start a new conversation (or continue an existing project for ongoing work)
3. **Step 3:** Use a standardised prompt template that specifies exactly what information to extract (task, owner, deadline, priority, status)
4. **Step 4:** Paste your notes or upload thedocument, then submit the prompt
5. **Step 5:** Review Claude's output for accuracy—check that all action items are captured and owners are correctly identified
6. **Step 6:** Copy the structured output into your team's task tracking system (Excel, Google Sheets, project management tool, or shareddocument)
7. **Step 7:** Make any necessary corrections and share with your admin team

Key Considerations

- AI may occasionally miss implicit action items or misidentify who's responsible—always review the output before sharing
- Establish a consistent prompt template and save it for reuse to ensure your task lists remain formatted consistently
- For meetings with complex discussions, AI might extract too many or too few items—you may need to provide guidance on what constitutes an'action item' vs general discussion
- If your team uses specific project management software (Asana, Monday.com, Trello), you might eventually want to explore automation tools like Zapier to import tasks directly, though starting with manual copy-paste is perfectly fine

UC-019: Email Intelligence

Yes, AI can help

Verdict

AI-powered email filtering is well-suited to this task, with multiple reliable tools available.

Department: Admin/Office | **Role:** PA/Office Manager

Task Description

I receive emails where senders say things like "needs to go out today" or "urgent - please action immediately." I want these flagged so they don't get buried in my inbox.

Reasoning

For basic keyword matching (e.g., flagging emails containing 'urgent' or specific phrases), native Outlook rules may be sufficient and require no additional tools or subscriptions. AI-powered solutions become valuable when you need more sophisticated urgency detection beyond simple keyword matching—understanding context, interpreting varied phrasing, or learning from your specific patterns. This task involves pattern recognition (identifying urgency indicators in email text), consistent rule application, and automation—all areas where AI tools excel. Multiple established solutions exist specifically for this problem, from AI-powered email clients to background filtering services.

The risk profile is favourable: false positives (flagging non-urgent emails) cause minor inconvenience, while false negatives (missing urgent emails) are easily corrected through periodic inbox reviews. The information source is your own email, which you already access through email clients, so no additional data exposure occurs beyond what your existing email provider already processes.

For UK SMBs, several GDPR-compliant options exist. SaneBox offers the strongest privacy protection by analysing only email headers rather than full content. Alternative AI email clients like Shortwave or Superhuman provide more sophisticated urgency detection but require reading full email content. The choice depends on your organisation's data sensitivity requirements and whether you use Gmail, Outlook, or other providers.

Recommended Approach

Tool: SaneBox or Shortwave AI

Method: Set up an AI email filtering service that monitors your inbox continuously and automatically flags or moves emails based on urgency indicators. The service learns your patterns and applies consistent rules without manual intervention.

Implementation Steps

1. **Step 1:** Choose your tool based on email provider: SaneBox works with any IMAP/Exchange (Outlook, Gmail, iCloud); Shortwave requires Gmail only
2. **Step 2:** Sign up and connect your email account via secure OAuth (no password sharing required)
3. **Step 3:** Configure urgency filters by specifying keywords ('urgent', 'today', 'ASAP', 'immediately') and sender priority rules
4. **Step 4:** Set up visual indicators: SaneBox uses folder-based organisation; Shortwave uses AI-powered inbox sections and priority flags
5. **Step 5:** Test with a one-week trial period, checking filtered results daily to ensure accuracy
6. **Step 6:** Adjust sensitivity settings based on false positives/negatives during the trial period

Key Considerations

- AI may initially misclassify emails until it learns your specific patterns—plan for a 1-2 week training period
- Urgency language varies by sender culture; some colleagues may never use explicit urgency indicators
- False negatives (missed urgent emails) are the bigger risk—set up a daily digest of filtered emails as backup
- Email filtering services require ongoing access to your inbox; verify this aligns with your organisation's IT security policies
- If your inbox receives highly confidential information, consult IT before granting third-party access

UC-020: Research

Partially suitable

Verdict

> AI can assist with research and comparison but cannot directly book hotels or access real-time pricing data.

Department: Admin/Office | **Role:** PA/Office Manager

Task Description

> *When booking accommodation for staff site visits, I spend time searching multiple hotel sites to find the cheapest options near the site location. I need to find available hotels, compare prices, and book within our company policy limits.*

Reasoning

This task splits into two distinct phases with different AI suitability. The research and comparison phase is moderately suited to AI assistance, while the actual booking phase is not.

AI tools like Claude can help you draft search criteria, summarise accommodation options from information you provide, and compare options against your company policy. However, AI cannot directly access live hotel booking websites, check real-time availability, or see current pricing. The free-tier Claude.ai has no internet access for live searches, and even with web search capabilities (available in some paid tiers), AI cannot interact with booking forms or complete transactions. This is fundamentally different from tasks like document analysis where AI excels.

The most practical AI use here is as a research assistant once you've gathered preliminary information. You can paste details about 3-5 hotel options (name, location, price, amenities) and ask Claude to create a comparison table highlighting which best meet your criteria (proximity to site, policy limits, value for money). This saves time on manual comparison but doesn't eliminate the manual research phase. For truly automated hotel searching and booking, you'd need specialist travel management software or a travel management company—not self-service AI tools.

Recommended Approach

Tool: Claude.ai (Free or Pro)

Method: Use Claude to create comparison frameworks and analyse options you've manually gathered from booking sites. It can highlight best value, flag policy concerns, and draft communication to managers or hotels.

Implementation Steps

1. **Step 1:** Manually search 3-5 booking sites (Booking.com, Hotels.com, company preferred suppliers) and note down 4-6 viable options with key details (name, address, distance from site, price per night, amenities, cancellation policy)
2. **Step 2:** Open Claude.ai and paste your gathered information with context: site location, dates needed, number of staff, company policy limits (e.g., '£120/night maximum for standard visits')
3. **Step 3:** Ask Claude to create a comparison table highlighting which options best meet your criteria, calculate total costs including any extras, and flag any policy concerns
4. **Step 4:** Use Claude to draft a booking request email or generate a quick summary for expense approval if the selected option requires manager sign-off
5. **Step 5:** Complete the actual booking manually on the chosen hotel's website or via your company's preferred booking method
6. **Step 6:** Save Claude's comparison as a record for expense claims or future reference

Key Considerations

- AI cannot access real-time hotel availability or pricing—you must gather this information manually first
- Booking.com, Expedia, and similar sites use dynamic pricing that changes constantly; AI comparisons are only valid at the moment you provide the data
- Company travel policies may require using specific booking platforms or preferred suppliers—check this before researching
- AI cannot complete booking transactions or interact with payment systems for security reasons
- For recurring site visits to the same location, traditional solutions (corporate travel management accounts, pre-negotiated hotel rates) will be more efficient than AI-assisted ad-hoc searches

UC-021: Expense Automation

Partially suitable

Verdict

> AI can help verify distances and fill forms, but cannot automatically validate actual routes taken or detect fraudulent claims.

Department: Admin/Office | **Role:** PA/Office Manager

Task Description

> *Staff submit mileage claims for site visits. I need to verify the distances claimed are accurate by checking the route from their start location to the site. Then I fill in the mileage form with the verified distances.*

Reasoning

This task involves two distinct components with different AI suitability levels.

The distance verification aspect is partially suitable for AI. Tools like ChatGPT, Claude, or Google's Gemini can calculate distances between two locations using their web search capabilities or by querying mapping services. However, they cannot verify that the claimed route was the actual route taken, nor can they account for legitimate variations (diversions, traffic conditions, multiple stops). AI will typically provide the most direct route distance, which may differ from reality. For fraud detection or pattern analysis across multiple claims, AI could flag anomalies, but human judgement remains essential.

The form-filling component is well-suited to AI assistance. Once distances are verified, AI can help populate standardised mileage claim forms efficiently, especially if you're working with digital documents. However, the overall workflow remains partially suitable because the critical verification step—confirming the legitimacy of the claim—requires human oversight and cannot be fully automated without risking approval of inaccurate claims.

Recommended Approach

Tool: Claude.ai (Free or Pro)

Method: Use Claude to verify distances via web search, then assist with populating the mileage form template. This creates a semi-automated workflow where AI handles distance lookups and form drafting, while you retain oversight.

Implementation Steps

1. **Step 1:** Gather the week's mileage claims showing employee names, start locations, destinations, and claimed distances
2. **Step 2:** For each claim, prompt Claude:'What is the driving distance from [start location] to [destination]?' using web search
3. **Step 3:** Compare Claude's verified distances against claimed distances, noting any significant discrepancies (>10% variance)
4. **Step 4:** For discrepancies, investigate further—contact the employee to understand if there were legitimate reasons for the difference
5. **Step 5:** Once verified, provide Claude with your mileage form template and the verified distances, asking it to populate the form
6. **Step 6:** Review the populated form for accuracy before submitting for payment approval

Key Considerations

- AI provides direct route distances only—it cannot verify the actual route taken or account for legitimate diversions, traffic delays, or multiple site visits on one journey
- Significant discrepancies require human investigation; AI cannot determine intent (genuine error vs. fraudulent claim)
- Home addresses as start locations constitute personal data under UK GDPR—anonymise or use appropriate tier subscriptions
- If using free AI tiers, disable data training in settings before inputting any employee information
- For high-volume processing (50+ claims weekly), consider automation tools with mapping API integration rather than manual AI prompting

UC-022: Contract Generation

Partially suitable

Verdict

AI can assist with drafting but legal documents require professional review and this task carries employment law risks that demand human oversight.

Department: Admin/Office | **Role:** PA/Office Manager

Task Description

When we hire new staff, I need to create their service agreement by taking key details from the offer letter (salary, start date, job title, working hours) and putting them into our standard agreement template. I also need to ensure the terms are consistent with what was offered.

Reasoning

Employment contracts are legally binding documents where errors can create significant liability for your organisation. AI tools like Claude can effectively extract key details from offer letters and populate template agreements, which addresses the mechanical aspects of your task efficiently. However, several factors prevent a higher suitability rating.

First, employment contracts in the UK are governed by the Employment Rights Act 1996 and must comply with specific statutory requirements. AI cannot guarantee legal compliance or identify potential conflicts between offer terms and standard contract clauses. Second, there are substantial GDPR considerations—offer letters contain personal data (names, addresses, salary details, potentially NI numbers) which should not be input into free-tier AI tools. Third, even with enterprise AI tools, the output requires verification by someone with employment law knowledge to ensure consistency, compliance, and appropriate risk allocation.

The task is well-suited for AI assistance as a first draft generator, but the legal nature and potential for employment disputes mean you should never use AI-generated contracts without proper legal review. This is particularly critical as you've identified this could affect relationships (presumably with the new employee), and employment tribunal claims can be costly. The practical value is in speeding up the drafting process, not replacing legal oversight.

Recommended Approach

Tool: Claude Pro with anonymisation

Method: Use Claude to create a draft by providing your template and anonymised offer details, then have your legal advisor or HR specialist review for compliance and accuracy before finalisation.

Implementation Steps

1. **Step 1:** Step 1: Anonymise the offer letter—replace candidate name with 'Jane Smith', use 'XX High Street, London' for address, round salary to nearest £5k, remove any personal identifiers
2. **Step 2:** Step 2: Upload your standard agreement template and the anonymised offer letter to Claude Pro (not free tier—£16/month required for business use)
3. **Step 3:** Step 3: Ask Claude to extract the key terms and populate the template, flagging any inconsistencies or unusual clauses
4. **Step 4:** Step 4: Review the draft yourself against the original offer letter to verify accuracy of all extracted details
5. **Step 5:** Step 5: Have your legal advisor, HR consultant, or employment law specialist review the completed agreement before use
6. **Step 6:** Step 6: Replace anonymised details with actual candidate information only in the final, reviewed version

Key Considerations

- Employment contracts are legal documents—AI-generated drafts require review by someone qualified in UK employment law before use
- Errors in employment contracts can lead to tribunal claims, statutory payment disputes, and damage to employee relations
- Offer letters often contain personal data protected by UK GDPR—you must anonymise before using AI tools or face potential data protection breaches
- Standard templates may need adjustment for specific roles, circumstances, or recent employment law changes that AI cannot track
- If your organisation has template agreements already vetted by legal advisors, deviating from those templates (even with AI assistance) may introduce unreviewed risks
- Some employment terms are legally required (written statement of particulars within 2 months of start date under Employment Rights Act 1996)—AI cannot guarantee statutory compliance

UC-023: Compliance Documentation

Probably suitable

Verdict

AI can effectively draft and structure ISO policy documents, but this task requires expert verification due to compliance requirements and the formal nature of management system documentation.

Department: Admin/Office | **Role:** PA/Office Manager

Task Description

I need to create and update policy documents for our ISO management system. We have existing documents that need refreshing and some new policies to write. The policies need to follow ISO standards format and be consistent with our other IMS documents.

Reasoning

ISO management system policies are well-suited to AI assistance because they follow standardised formats, require consistent terminology across documents, and benefit from AI's ability to maintain coherent structure. Claude can analyse your existing IMS documents to understand your organisation's style, extract key requirements from ISO standards, and draft policies that align with established frameworks.

However, this task carries moderate risk because ISO policies form the foundation of your certified management system. Errors, inconsistencies with actual practices, or misalignment with ISO requirements could affect audit outcomes and client confidence. The "could affect client/customer relationships" risk level is appropriate—poorly written policies won't cause immediate harm, but they represent your organisation's commitment to quality/environmental/safety management.

The recommended approach is to use AI for initial drafting and consistency checking, while ensuring a competent person (someone familiar with your ISO system and the relevant standards) reviews all outputs before implementation. AI excels at structure and consistency but cannot verify that policies accurately reflect your actual processes or meet your certification body's specific expectations.

Recommended Approach

Tool: Claude.ai Pro

Method: Upload 3-5 existing IMS policies to establish your organisation's style and terminology, then provide ISO standard requirements and ask Claude to draft new policies or refresh existing ones while maintaining consistency. Work iteratively, reviewing and refining sections before finalising.

Implementation Steps

1. **Step 1:** Gather 3-5 representative existing IMS policies (quality, environmental, H&S procedures) and save them as PDFs or Word documents. Remove any genuinely confidential client-specific information if present.
2. **Step 2:** Create a new conversation in Claude.ai Pro and upload your existing policies using the paperclip icon. Add a prompt explaining your IMS scope, relevant ISO standards (9001, 14001,45001, etc.), and which new policy you need to create first.
3. **Step 3:** Ask Claude to analyse the uploaded documents and summarise your organisation's policy structure, standard clauses, and terminology conventions before drafting anything new.
4. **Step 4:** Request a first draft of the new policy, specifying required sections (Purpose, Scope, Responsibilities, Policy Statement, Related Documents, Review Schedule) and any specific ISO requirements to address.
5. **Step 5:** Review the draft critically against the actual ISO standard requirements and your organisation's practices. Ask Claude to revise specific sections, adjust terminology, or strengthen commitments as needed.
6. **Step 6:** Once satisfied with the content, have your ISO Management Representative or a competent person conduct a final review before adding the policy to your controlled document system.

Key Considerations

- AI cannot verify that policies accurately reflect your actual organisational practices—this requires someone with operational knowledge of your systems
- ISO auditors assess whether policies are implemented as written, not just whether they're well-written—ensure drafted policies describe what you actually do
- Your certification body may have specific formatting or content expectations that AI won't know unless you explicitly describe them
- Policy review and approval workflows must follow yourdocument control procedures—AI-generated content still requires authorised approval before release

- AI may generate plausible-sounding ISO terminology that doesn't precisely match the standard's requirements—verify specific clause references against the actual ISO standard text

---

www.aisolutionhub.co.uk | liam@aisolutionhub.co.uk

Report generated: 16 January 2026